

WHISCO TV ❖❖❖ 12-month growth playbook

Oct 2026 ❖❖❖ Sep 2027

WHISCO TV — 12-month growth playbook

Oct 2026 – Sep 2027

Free, legal, 100% ad-supported streaming for GCC expats.
whisco.tv · 5 September 2026 · operator-facing, not an investor deck.

This document is four systems one founder can run with an AI agent:

1. Cultural-calendar campaigns
2. Meta Ads at **USD 110 / month**
3. App Store / Play ASO
4. WhatsApp Channel (the trust layer)

Doctrines that override every tactic

- No piracy language. Ever. Anti-pirate is the brand.
- No invented MAU, installs, or “viral” claims. Early-stage. Mark every target as a *projection*.
- Community posts are human-only. Automation drafts; a person publishes.
- Max one ad per page, never next to the player. Ads creative must match that honesty.
- Apps collect zero data until v1.1. Do not run in-app Meta/Firebase SDKs before store approval + privacy-label change.
- No subscriptions. “Free forever” is not a slogan you walk back.
- Executable by ≤2 people. If a plan needs a community manager, a media buyer and a designer, it is the wrong plan.

Sources used (already in the data room)

- Gulf expat community map (58 rooms; WhatsApp = trust; Expat.com Bahrain / r/cordcutters / r/ABCDesis as answer-first rooms)
- SEO long-tail query bank (~245 legal-intent queries)
- Competitive brief (ad overload, billing surprises, buffering = the three complaints we design against)
- Catalog facts as of 5 Sep 2026: 581 live channels, 15,696 VOD titles (61 Turkish series / ~3,650 eps, 333 Arabic series / ~7,100 eps, 2,500+ Hindi cinema, 672 Malayalam)

Islamic dates below are **expected / Umm al-Qura + Gulf News / Khaleej Times astronomy as of Aug-Sep 2026**. Confirm 48 hours before each campaign with the official

moon-sighting announcement. Do not print “Ramadan starts 8 Feb” on a poster until the committee speaks.

Operating cadence (the only calendar the founder needs)

Day	Work	Timebox
Sunday	Draft next week’s WhatsApp posts + any seasonal landing page	90 min
Monday	Publish WhatsApp Week-opener. Check Meta spend vs cap. Kill losers.	30 min
Wednesday	One human community reply (Expatriate.com / Industrious / a Facebook group you already belong to). Never cold-spam.	20 min
Friday	Publish WhatsApp weekend watch list. Screenshot ASO experiment if a store listing is live.	30 min
Last Sunday of month	Write the monthly scorecard (table at the end). Decide next month’s \$110 split.	45 min

That is the whole operating system. Seasonal campaigns plug into it; they do not replace it.

1. Twelve-month marketing calendar

How to read a month

- *Campaign* = the one idea we say out loud.
- *Assets* = what must exist before spend or posting. If the asset is missing, skip the paid push and run organic only.
- *Community* = who we talk to, in their language, in rooms we already mapped.
- *KPI* = leading indicators we can actually see (WhatsApp follows, site sessions from Vercel Web Analytics, store listing visitors, Meta CTR/CPC). **Not MAU we have not earned.**

Default paid burst per campaign: **USD 15–35** from the \$110 pool, never more than 40% of the month on one idea. Ramadan is the only month allowed to take 60%.

October 2026 — “Legal living-room setup” + Durga Puja / Dussehra

Why this month exists. Apps are still coming out of review. School mid-term in the UAE is 12–18 Oct. Durga Puja Ashtami/Navami 19 Oct, Dussehra 20 Oct. Navratri from ~11 Oct. Turkish 2026–27 season already on air (Star / ATV / Kanal D / NOW premieres landed 1–18 Sep). This is a *utility* month, not a festival blowout.

Field	Plan
Campaign	<i>Apartment TV without the Firestick headache.</i> Honest setup guide: legal live + VOD on phone and Smart TV. Side-car: <i>Durga Puja / Dussehra watch-from-the-Gulf</i> for Bengali + Hindi homes.
Assets	1) “Legal TV in a GCC apartment” page (EN + HI). 2) Bengali + Hindi festival shelf graphic. 3) 3 store screenshots if Play/iOS are live. 4) WhatsApp posters ×4.
Community	Expat.com Bahrain Firestick threads (answer-first). Indusladies UAE. Bengali + Hindi WhatsApp. r/ABCDesis only if a Jadoo thread is already running.
KPI (projections)	4 human replies posted. Festival landing indexed. WhatsApp Channel +25 follows. Meta test: 3 creatives, kill 2.

Do not spend against “IPL” or “Ramadan” yet. Do not promise sports rights we do not have.

November 2026 — Diwali + Chhath + Guru Nanak

Dates. Diwali / Lakshmi Puja **8 Nov 2026**. Chhath **15–16 Nov**. Guru Nanak Jayanti **24 Nov**. UAE National Day 2–4 Dec is next door — do not mix the two.

Field	Plan
Campaign	<i>Diwali living room — 2,500+ official Hindi films, no signup, no dish.</i> Separate 48-hour Chhath post for Bihari/Jharkhandi + Bhojpuri-leaning homes. One Punjabi/Sikh post on the 24th pointing at Punjabi cinema + news FTA, not a religious lecture.
Assets	Dark-UI Diwali key art (orange → pink on #0a0a0f, diya, not clip-art fireworks). Hindi

Field	Plan
	film shelf URL. 15-second Reel: “open, tap Hindi, play — no card.”
Community	Indian FB groups you already sit in. Pakistanis-in-Dubai only for the Guru Nanak adjacent Punjabi slice if the group culture allows helpful posts. Avoid ExpatWoman product URLs.
KPI	Diwali week Meta burst \$25–35. Reel thumb-stop rate >25% or kill. Landing page sessions tracked in Vercel (report the number; do not forecast it).

Tone: homesickness is real; do not write “celebrate like you’re in Mumbai.” Write “the film is legal, the stream is stable, nobody is billing you at 2 a.m.”

December 2026 — Simbang Gabi / Christmas + winter school break

Dates. UAE winter break **14 Dec 2026 – 3 Jan 2027**. Simbang Gabi **16–24 Dec**. Christmas **25 Dec**. Filipino Christmas season in the Gulf starts in September culturally; we only turn the volume up in December.

Field	Plan
Campaign	<i>Pasko in the Gulf — teleserye + movies on the phone after shift</i> . Parallel EN/AR “winter-break family TV” for mixed households (Arabic series 333 titles / 7,100 eps + Hindi + kids-safe FTA).
Assets	Tagalog + EN poster. “What is free vs what still needs iWantTFC/OSN Pinoy” honesty card — we do not pretend we replaced ABS-CBN. One Smart-TV screenshot.
Community	Pilipino Sa Kuwait page comments, Dubai Filipino Community, OFW WhatsApp. Human voice, Taglish allowed.
KPI	8 WhatsApp posts in the month (double cadence 16–26 Dec). Zero cold links in gated “Filipino Mums” groups.

Complaint we design against: iWantTFC “8 ads then the video dies.” Our copy: one display ad, never on the player.

January 2027 — Pongal / Sankranti + cricket warm-up

Dates. Pongal / Makar Sankranti **14–17 Jan.** Border-Gavaskar Trophy window **21 Jan – 3 Mar** (India home). PSL 2027 window is **unconfirmed** (broadcasters floating January; franchises want April). We do **not** sell PSL or IPL streams. We sell “something to watch when the match is on a paid app.”

Field	Plan
Campaign	<i>Pongal week for Tamil + Telugu Gulf homes. Secondary: Match-day companion — legal FTA + VOD for the hours around cricket you already pay TOD/beIN/Starz to watch.</i>
Assets	Tamil / Telugu festival shelf. Honest sports page: “We do not carry IPL or PSL rights. Here is what <i>is</i> legal and free tonight.”
Community	r/kollywood and r/tollywood only as comments on existing “where to watch in UAE” threads. Tamil/Telugu WhatsApp.
KPI	Sports-honesty page live before 21 Jan. One Meta ad set against Tamil language + UAE/SA.

If PSL lands in January, run a Pakistani-drama companion burst (\$15), not a pirate-stream bait-and-switch.

February 2027 — Ramadan launch (the year-defining push)

Expected. First fast **Mon 8 Feb 2027**. Last fast **~9 Mar**. Laylat al-Qadr **~6 Mar**. Confirm locally.

Ramadan is the Gulf’s television season. Shahid/MBC will own Arabic originals. Our gap is **multi-language iftar-to-suhoor** for mixed expat flats: Arabic series + Turkish dizi (61 series, ~3,650 eps) + Urdu/Hindi serials + Filipino late-night, with an ad load that does not insult people who just broke their fast.

Field	Plan
Campaign	<i>Ramadan free drama — legal, no signup, one ad.</i> Sub-lines per community: Arabic series shelf; Turkish with AR/EN path; Pakistani / Hindi serials after iftar; “quiet hour” kids-safe FTA before tarawih.
Assets	Ramadan hub page (EN + AR). Iftar timetable <i>is not ours to publish as religious authority</i> — link a known source, don’t

Field	Plan
	invent prayer times. 6 posters (AR, EN, UR, HI, TR-EN, TL). 3 Reels: “open after maghrib, no password.”
Community	Arabic-speaking expats + Turkish dizi rooms (value-first, no bootleg links). Pakistani Dubai groups. Do not post in unofficial Osman/EN-sub Telegram dumps.
KPI	60% of February’s \$110 on this idea from 1 Feb. Daily spend cap. Creative refresh every 7 days because Ramadan CPM inflates (UAE/SA often 1.8–2.5×). WhatsApp daily 1 Feb–10 Mar is allowed — the only month we break the 3×/week cap.

Copy rules in Ramadan: no food-porn iftar that feels like a restaurant ad. No “watch instead of praying.” Frame: the house is full, the stream should just work.

March 2027 — Eid al-Fitr + IPL start + Holi

Expected. Eid al-Fitr **9 or 10 Mar 2027** (UAE school Eid window 8–12 Mar). IPL 2027 *targeted* window **10 Mar – 15 May** (BCCI discussion, not a locked fixture list). Holi **22–23 Mar**.

Field	Plan
Campaign	Week 1: <i>Eid binge — finished series, family films, no billing surprise</i> . Week 3: Holi colour board for Hindi/Punjabi. All month: <i>IPL companion</i> , never <i>IPL stream</i> .
Assets	Eid key art. “Finished Turkish + Arabic series” collection (use the 61 + 333 counts honestly). Holi static. Sports companion page already live from January.
Community	Same Ramadan rooms, plus Indian family groups for Holi.
KPI	Eid 72-hour organic burst. Meta \$20 only if February CPMs have cooled. Do not bid against every telco’s Eid ad.

April 2027 — Spring break + New Year festivals + IPL mid-season

Dates. UAE spring break **5–11 Apr**. Ugadi / Gudi Padwa ~**7 Apr**. Baisakhi **13–14 Apr**. Vishu **14 Apr**. IPL ongoing.

Field	Plan
Campaign	<i>School-break watch list</i> (family + kids-safe FTA). Language spikes: Telugu/Kannada/Marathi for Ugadi-Gudi; Punjabi for Baisakhi; Malayalam for Vishu.
Assets	Four 1:1 language posters, one Smart-TV how-to for parents home on break.
Community	Indusladies (mums, experience-reply style). InterNations Manama only as event-adjacent conversation, not a booth.
KPI	Four language posts. Meta \$15 on Punjabi + Malayalam (cheaper, tighter).

May 2027 — Eid al-Adha + IPL close

Expected. Arafah ~**15–16 May**, Eid al-Adha ~**16–18 May**. IPL final targeted ~**15 May**.

Field	Plan
Campaign	<i>Eid al-Adha long-weekend watch.</i> Secondary: “season over — here is a series that is actually finished.”
Assets	Reuse Ramadan hub with Adha skin. No new video unless a licensed own-player title actually landed.
Community	Family WhatsApp. Pakistani + Indian cricket groups get the <i>companion</i> message one last time.
KPI	Organic-heavy. Paid cap \$15. Save budget for Onam/dizi in Aug–Sep.

June 2027 — Quiet product month + Islamic New Year

Dates. Hijri New Year **6 Jun**. Ashura **15 Jun**. Asia Cup targeted **18 Jun – 4 Jul**. School still in session until **2 Jul**.

Field	Plan
Campaign	No festival blowout. <i>App hygiene month</i> : store reviews, screenshot A/B, dead-channel report, ASO keyword pass. One sober Ashura/Muharram note — no “celebration” framing.

Field	Plan
Assets	Updated store screenshots from real devices. Review-response templates go live (section 3).
Community	Reply to every store review within 48 hours. That <i>is</i> the marketing.
KPI	100% review response rate. ASO experiment #2 shipped. Meta paused or \$10 brand-search only.

July 2027 — Summer at home / summer back-home

Dates. UAE academic year ends **2 Jul**. Many expats fly home; many others stay and run the AC.

Field	Plan
Campaign	<i>Gulf summer TV — the legal thing on the apartment TV while the house is half-empty.</i> Split creative: stay-back workers vs families who travelled (app on the phone in Kerala/Kerala-adjacent is <i>not</i> a geo we promise; do not advertise India availability we have not checked).
Assets	“Works on GCC Wi-Fi” badge. Heat/AC visual, not a beach.
Community	Labour-camp and shift-worker WhatsApp only if we already have a trusted admin relationship. Never scrape groups.
KPI	Organic + \$20 Meta in BH/OM/KW (cheaper CPM, stay-back audiences).

August 2027 — Independence days + Mawlid + dizi pre-season

Dates. PH Independence was June; **Ninoy Aquino Day 21 Aug**, National Heroes’ Day **30 Aug**. India Independence 15 Aug. Pakistan 14 Aug. Mawlid ~**15 Aug**. Janmashtami ~**4–5 Aug**. Raksha Bandhan ~**9 Aug**. Turkish 2027–28 season marketing starts late August.

Field	Plan
Campaign	Three 48-hour national-day posts (PK 14, IN 15, PH 21/30) — catalogue + live FTA, not flag-waving politics. Then <i>New dizi season — legal HD, not 360p Telegram</i> .

Field	Plan
Assets	Country-day posters. Dizi landing: 61 series / ~3,650 episodes, official sources, AR + EN path.
Community	r/TurkishTVSerials value-first (where to watch legally). Do not drop links in unofficial EN-sub Telegram.
KPI	Dizi page live by 25 Aug. Meta \$25 on Turkish-interest + EN/AR language in AE/SA/BH.

September 2027 — Onam + new dizi season + year-two reset

Dates. Ganesh Chaturthi **4 Sep 2027**. Onam / Thiruvonam **12 Sep 2027**. New school year **30 Aug 2027**. This is also the anniversary window of the live site (20 Aug 2026).

Field	Plan
Campaign	<i>Onam for Gulf Malayalis — 672 Malayalam titles, legal, no ManoramaMAX bill shock.</i> Twin campaign: <i>New season dizi, still free.</i>
Assets	Onam key art (pookalam on dark UI, not stock sadya). Malayalam shelf URL. Year-one honest letter: what shipped, what is still missing (sports, own-player licensed depth).
Community	r/MalayalamMovies, Mallu WhatsApp you already belong to. Not Dubai Mallu Chat Telegram (explicit no-spam).
KPI	Onam week \$35. Malayalam-language ad set. Publish the 12-month scorecard. Decide whether \$110 still belongs on Meta or moves to ASO/creators.

Calendar at a glance

Month	Lead campaign	Paid \$ (of 110)	Intensity
Oct 2026	Legal apartment setup + Puja/Dussehra	25	Medium
Nov 2026	Diwali / Chhath / Guru Nanak	35	High

Month	Lead campaign	Paid \$ (of 110)	Intensity
Dec 2026	Simbang Gabi / Christmas / winter break	20	High organic
Jan 2027	Pongal + cricket companion	20	Medium
Feb 2027	Ramadan free drama	65	Peak
Mar 2027	Eid al-Fitr + Holi + IPL companion	20	High
Apr 2027	Spring break + Ugadi/Baisakhi/Vis hu	15	Medium
May 2027	Eid al-Adha + IPL close	15	Low-medium
Jun 2027	Store hygiene / Muharram restraint	0–10	Low
Jul 2027	Summer stay-back TV	20	Medium
Aug 2027	National days + dizi pre-season	25	Medium
Sep 2027	Onam + new dizi season	35	High

Unallocated dollars each month sit in reserve for a creative test or are simply not spent. Not spending the \$110 is a valid decision.

2. Meta Ads playbook — USD 110 / month

2.1 What this budget can and cannot do

At Gulf CPMs this is a **learning budget**, not a growth engine.

Indicative 2026 Meta CPMs (agency benches, not our account — treat as planning ranges):

Geo	Broad consumer CPM	Peak (Ramadan / National Day)	Notes
Bahrain	USD 4.50–8.50	10–16	Best test bed. Home market.
Oman	4.00–7.50	9–14	Cheap. Thin expat density vs AE/SA.

Geo	Broad consumer CPM	Peak (Ramadan / National Day)	Notes
Kuwait	6.50–11.50	14–22	Filipino + Indian density useful.
UAE	9.50–16 (~ AED 12–35 blended)	20–32	English-expat often AED 22–45. Expensive.
Saudi	8–14	18–28	Arabic-first creative wins. Huge Indian/Pak/Filipino labour audience.
Qatar	7.50–13	16–25	Small, rich, easy to overpay.

Reels/Stories often clear 20–30% cheaper CPM than Feed. Use them.

What \$110 buys in a normal month (projection, not a promise)

- Bahrain/Oman mix at \$6 CPM → ~18,000 impressions
- UAE at \$12 CPM → ~9,000 impressions
- CTR 1.0% on honest creative → 90–180 landing clicks
- CPC planning range USD 0.40–1.80 depending on geo and language

That is enough to learn which community + angle converts to a site session. It is not enough to “own Ramadan in the UAE.”

Do not turn on Advantage+ App Campaigns until both stores are public and the privacy label still says what we do. Until then, traffic objective → whisco.tv (or a campaign landing page). WhatsApp objective is allowed for Channel follows.

2.2 Account structure (one ad account, three campaigns max)

Keep it stupid. Three campaigns. No more.

Campaign	Objective	Default monthly \$	On when
C1 — Seasonal	Traffic (landing page)	50–65	The month’s lead campaign from section 1
C2 — Evergreen language	Traffic	30–40	Always, except when C1 is in Ramadan-peak
C3 — App / Channel	Traffic to store URL or WhatsApp	15–20	Only after the relevant store is public, or to grow the Channel

One campaign = one job. Do not mix Diwali and “install the app” in the same ad set.

Ad set rule: 1 ad set = 1 community × 1 geo-cluster × 1 language. Maximum **4 live ad sets** across the account. More ad sets than that on \$3.60/day starves the auction.

2.3 Audience definitions (BH / SA / AE)

Meta’s “Lived in [country] / Expats [country]” behaviours still exist in many accounts but **disappear and rename**. Rebuild from interests + language if a behaviour is missing. Do not stack eight interests; stack two.

Geo clusters

- *Test:* Bahrain only (home, cheap, founder can see the ads).
- *Scale-if-working:* Bahrain + Oman + Kuwait.
- *Paid-only-with-a-winner:* UAE or Saudi as their own ad sets. Never BH+AE+SA in one set — the auction will dump spend into the most expensive geo.

Language targeting (Ads Manager → Detailed targeting + Languages)

Community	Languages to set	Interest / behaviour seeds (pick 2–3, not 10)
Indian — Hindi	Hindi, English	Bollywood, Zee TV, Star Plus, IPL, Diwali, Hotstar <i>(interest only — we do not claim we are Hotstar)</i>
Malayalam	Malayalam, English	Onam, Mollywood, Kerala, Asianet
Tamil	Tamil, English	Kollywood, Tamil cinema, Pongal
Telugu	Telugu, English	Tollywood, Ugadi
Punjabi	Punjabi, English	Punjabi cinema, Baisakhi, PTC
Bengali	Bengali, English	Durga Puja, Kolkata, Tollywood (Bengali)
Pakistani	Urdu, English	Pakistani drama, ARY, Hum TV, cricket, PSL
Bangladeshi	Bengali, English	Cricket, Eid, Dhaka
Filipino	English, Filipino/Tagalog if offered	OFW, ABS-CBN, GMA, Simbang Gabi, OFW (behaviour)
Indonesian	Indonesian, English	Sinetron, RCTI, Ramadan
Nepali	Nepali, English	Nepal, cricket

Community	Languages to set	Interest / behaviour seeds (pick 2–3, not 10)
Sri Lankan	English, Sinhala / Tamil if offered	Cricket, Sri Lanka
Arab expats	Arabic, English	Shahid, Turkish drama, Ramadan series, MBC
Turkish-dizi fans	English, Arabic, Turkish	Turkish TV series, Ertuğrul, dizi, Netflix Turkish (<i>interest</i>)

Age / placement defaults

- Age 21–54. Under-21 burns CPM on low-intent scrollers.
- Placements: Advantage+ placements **off** at this budget. Manual: Instagram Reels, Facebook Reels, Stories, then Feed. No Audience Network. No Messenger inbox ads.
- Devices: mobile only until Smart-TV creative exists.

Exclusions

- Exclude lookalikes we do not have. We have no pixel history worth a lookalike until AdSense + analytics have a month of real events.
- Exclude “IPTV / Firestick reseller” interest clusters if they appear — brand safety.
- Exclude countries outside the six GCC states. We geo-fence content; do not pay for Egypt/India clicks we cannot serve.

2.4 Creative angles per audience

Every ad is one sentence + one proof + one URL. No montage of 14 languages. That reads as a scam IPTV ad.

Universal proof points we are allowed to use (facts)

- Free. No signup. No subscription.
- 581 live channels, health-checked every 6 hours.
- 15,696 on-demand titles, 13 languages.
- Official / FTA / public-domain sources. Not a pirate box.
- One ad on the page. Never on the player.
- Built in Bahrain.

Angles that match mapped complaints

Audience	Angle	First line (EN; translate in-language)
All	Anti-Firestick	“The apartment banned the dish. The stick keeps

Audience	Angle	First line (EN; translate in-language)
		freezing. This is the legal version.”
All	Anti-ad-overload	“Other apps stack five ads. We run one, and not on the video.”
All	Anti-billing	“No trial that becomes a 49-dirham surprise. Free is free.”
Hindi	Catalog proof	“2,500+ official Hindi films. Open and play.”
Malayalam	Onam / homesickness	“672 Malayalam titles. Legal in Bahrain and the UAE. No Indian SIM.”
Tamil / Telugu	Festival + serials	“Pongal / Ugadi week, on the phone, after shift.”
Pakistani	Drama after iftar	“Urdu dramas without a dish and without a grey subscription.”
Filipino	After-shift Pasko	“Teleserye on the phone. One ad. No eight-ad pile-up.”
Turkish fans	Legal HD vs 360p	“61 series, ~3,650 episodes, official sources. Not a Telegram dump.”
Arabic expats	Ramadan companion	“Free Arabic series shelf next to the Turkish one. No VIP wall on this page.”
Parents	School break	“Something on the TV that does not need your credit card.”

Creative formats that fit a two-person team

1. Static 1080×1080 poster (WhatsApp and Feed). Dark #0a0a0f, orange → pink gradient, one catalog number, one URL.
2. 1080×1920 Story/Reel: 8–12 seconds, screen recording of opening whisco.tv and tapping a language. Burned-in caption. No voiceover required.
3. Carousel only if we have four real screenshots. Never fake UI.

Shoot the Reel on the founder’s phone. Do not hire.

Banned creative

- Channel grids that look like an IPTV reseller panel.
- “5000+ channels sports beIN IPL” — we do not have those rights.
- Before/after of a pirate stick.
- Fake review stars or fake viewer counts.
- Women’s photos as decoration. Product UI or the dog, not stock models.

2.5 Kill / scale rules (non-negotiable at \$110)

Review every Monday. The numbers are small; the rules must be harsh.

Kill an ad if any of these is true after 800 impressions or \$8 spend (whichever first):

- CTR < 0.6%
- CPC > \$2.00
- Frequency > 3.5 in a 7-day window (we are annoying the same 400 people)
- Comments accuse us of IPTV / “is this legal?” and we have not replied in 12 hours
- Landing bounce is obviously a geo-fail (people outside GCC)

Pause an ad set if:

- It spent 40% of the month with zero measured site sessions in Vercel for that UTMed URL
- CPM > 2× the planning table for that geo without a CTR above 1.5%

Scale (the only scale we have):

- Move \$10 from a loser to a winner inside the same campaign.
- Duplicate a winning ad set into the *next* geo-cluster (BH winner → KW, not BH winner → all of UAE overnight).
- Never raise daily budget more than 20% in a day. The auction will just find more expensive people.

Ramadan exception

- Expect CPM +80–150% in AE/SA.
- Cap daily spend. Refresh creative every 7 days.
- If CPC crosses \$2.50, retreat to Bahrain-only and WhatsApp.

Pixel / tracking

- UTM every ad:
utm_source=meta&utm_medium=paid&utm_campaign=2026-11-diwali&utm_content=hi-static-01
- Read results in Vercel Web Analytics + Meta. Do not install a Meta Pixel that changes the apps’ “Data Not Collected” label. Web pixel on whisco.tv is a separate decision for counsel + PDPL; until that is written, rely on UTM + Vercel.

2.6 Weekly operator checklist

1. Spend to date vs \$110 cap.
 2. Four-or-fewer ad sets live.
 3. Every live ad has an UTM.
 4. Comment queue empty.
 5. No Audience Network, no outside-GCC geo.
 6. Winning static exported to WhatsApp the same week (paid creative becomes organic asset).
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3. ASO playbook — Play Store + App Store

Status at writing: Android in **closed testing** (26 testers). iOS **submitted 2 Sep 2026**. ASO work before public listing is metadata drafting + screenshot production. Do not buy install ads toward a closed test.

3.1 Positioning line (use everywhere)

Short: Free live TV & movies for Gulf expats. Legal. No signup.

Long (first 80 characters matter on Play):

Free legal live TV and movies for GCC expats — Hindi, Malayalam, Tamil, Arabic, Turkish and more. No subscription.

Do not lead with “581 channels.” IPTV spam already owns that number-shape. Lead with *legal + languages + free*.

3.2 Keyword matrices

Volumes are **not invented**. These are the query shapes Gulf expats type (from the SEO brief) mapped onto store-safe metadata. Re-check with Play Console / App Store Connect search suggestions after public launch.

Play Store — title / short / long

Play title cap 30 characters. Short description 80. Use the 30 on brand + category, push languages into short + long.

Title candidates (A/B two at a time, 30–45 days each)

Variant	Title (≤30)	Hypothesis
A	Whisco TV: Free Live TV	Brand + head term
B	Whisco TV: Free Expat TV	Differentiator vs Plex/Fawesome
C	Whisco TV: Hindi Tamil Live	Language-first (use only if A/B stall)

Never put “IPTV”, “unblocked”, “beIN”, “Hotstar” in the title.

Short-description variants (80 chars)

- Free legal live TV & movies for Gulf expats. Hindi, Malayalam, Arabic, Turkish.
- Watch free live TV and films in 13 languages. No signup. Built in Bahrain.
- Legal free TV for UAE, Saudi & Bahrain expats. One ad. No subscription.

Long-description keyword blocks (write in sentences, not comma-stuffing)

Cover each GCC storefront with the same English body plus a short native paragraph.

Country storefront	Must-appear phrases (natural prose)
UAE	free live TV UAE, free movies Dubai, Hindi serials UAE, Malayalam TV Dubai, Filipino TV UAE, watch TV online UAE, legal live TV apartment
Saudi	free live TV Saudi, Hindi channels Saudi Arabia, Urdu dramas KSA, free movies Riyadh, watch TV online Saudi
Bahrain	free live TV Bahrain, Malayalam TV Bahrain, free movies Manama, legal streaming Bahrain
Qatar / Kuwait / Oman	same pattern: free live TV [country], [language] TV [country], no subscription

Language terms to rotate through the long description (all factual): Hindi, Bollywood, Malayalam, Tamil, Telugu, Punjabi, Bengali, Urdu, Pakistani drama, Tagalog, Filipino, Indonesian, Nepali, Sinhala, Arabic series, Turkish series, English subtitles, live TV, free movies, no signup, GCC, Bahrain, UAE, Saudi.

Do not stuff competitor brand names as if we were them. One honest line is allowed: “A legal alternative to a pirate Firestick — not a replacement for Shahid VIP or beIN sports.”

App Store — name / subtitle / keyword field

Name cap 30. Subtitle 30. Keyword field 100 (comma-separated, no spaces after commas, no duplication of words already in name/subtitle).

Name: Whisco TV

Subtitle A: Free Live TV & Movies

Subtitle B: Free Expat TV — Legal

Subtitle C: Hindi Tamil Arabic Turkish

Keyword field draft (100-character budget — count before shipping)

live tv, free
movies, expat, hindi, malayalam, tamil, arabic, turkish, urdu, filipino, gcc, bahrain

That string is 95 characters. Country-specific Connect localizations:

Localization	Extra keywords to swap in
English (U.A.E.)	dubai,uae,sharjah
English (Saudi Arabia)	ksa,riyadh,jeddah
Arabic	بث مباشر, مسلسلات, افلام, مجاني
Hindi	if Connect offers it — फ्री, टीवी, फिल्में

Apple does not use the long description for ranking the way Google does. Put the sales writing in the description; put the raw terms in the keyword field.

3.3 Screenshot and icon A/B plan

Icon (do this once, then leave it)

- Dark field #0a0a0f, orange–pink mark, readable at 16 px.
- Do not put “FREE” on the icon. Looks like adware.
- Do not use a generic play-button. That is 40% of the Entertainment category.
- Test only if organic icon tap-through is weak after 1,000 store impressions.

Screenshot narrative (6 frames, same set for Play + iOS, localized text overlays)

1. Hero: “Free legal TV for Gulf expats.” UI in the dark theme.
2. Language shelf: 13-language proof.
3. Live TV: a real channel grid that is FTA/official — **no sports-rights collage**.
4. On demand: Hindi + Turkish + Arabic tiles with real titles from the catalog.
5. Honesty card: “One ad. Never on the video. No subscription.”
6. Device: phone + TV-looking web UI. Caption: “Works in the apartment. No dish.”

A/B sequence (public listing only)

Window	Test	Winner rule
Days 1–30	Screenshot 1 headline: “Free legal TV” vs “No signup. 13 languages.”	Store listing conversion rate (Play) / Product Page conversion (iOS)
Days 31–60	Frame 5 honesty card first vs last	Same
Days 61–90	Malayalam-first vs Hindi-first on AE storefront; Arabic-first on SA	Compare AE vs SA separately
After 90	Icon test only if conversion < category median	30-day hold

One variable at a time. Custom product pages on iOS (UAE vs Saudi) are worth doing; they are free.

Preview video (optional, 15–30 s)

Screen recording only. No licensed trailer we do not have rights to cut. No trending audio that implies a film we don't carry.

3.4 Store listing copy — complaints we write against

From the competitive brief, users already hate: stacked ads, paid-still-has-ads, buffering, surprise billing, missing subs. Our listing should pre-answer those in the first three bullets.

Suggested bullet block:

- Free forever. No trial. No card.
- Legal sources only — official channels, FTA, public domain. Not IPTV.
- Hindi, Malayalam, Tamil, Telugu, Urdu, Arabic, Turkish and more.
- One display ad on the page. Never on the player.
- No account required. Watchlist stays on the device.

3.5 Review-response templates

Respond in the language of the review. 48-hour SLA. Never argue. Never offer a pirate workaround.

Positive (5★) > Thank you — that helps more than a billboard. If a channel ever dies, it should hide itself within six hours; if it doesn't, email legal@whisco.tv and we will look.

Ads complaint > You should see at most one ad, and not on the video. If a slot is stacked or covering the player, send a screenshot to legal@whisco.tv. We do not run pop-unders.

“Where is IPL / beIN / Hotstar?” > We don't carry paid sports or India-only apps. Those rights sit with TOD, beIN, StarzPlay and the official broadcasters. Whisco is the free legal shelf around that — live FTA and on-demand in 13 languages, no subscription.

Buffering > Live channels are official/FTA feeds and they do fail. They are health-checked every six hours and hidden when they die. If a title is buffering on a good connection, tell us the title + country + network (Wi-Fi / 5G) at legal@whisco.tv.

“Is this IPTV / legal?” > Yes, legal — official broadcaster embeds, free-to-air, public domain, or contracted files. We do not sell playlists, we do not unlock pay-TV, and we will take a title down the same day on a valid notice.

Billing / “it charged me” > Whisco does not take payments. If a charge appeared, it is not us — check Google Play / App Store subscriptions and any other app with a similar name. Write to us if you want help reading a screenshot.

Geo / “doesn't work in India / Egypt” > The catalog is cleared for the six GCC states. Titles that are not cleared are hidden rather than shown broken. We are not a VPN service.

Feature request > Logged. We ship as a two-person team, so we will not promise a date. The next honest place to look is the WhatsApp Channel.

1★ rage with no detail > Sorry it failed you. If you can tell us device + country + what you tapped, we can actually fix it. legal@whisco.tv

Do not buy reviews. Do not reply from a second account.

3.6 ASO work the founder does monthly (30 min)

1. Read Play Console / App Store Connect queries (once public).
 2. Swap *one* subtitle or short-description string.
 3. Answer every review.
 4. Check that screenshots still match the live UI.
 5. Confirm privacy labels still say Data Not Collected.
-

4. WhatsApp Channel content system

WhatsApp is the trust layer in this market. Facebook groups tolerate some help. Telegram movie channels are brand-unsafe. Reddit is answer-first. The Channel is the only owned surface where we can post without begging a moderator.

Setup rules

- One Channel: **Whisco TV**. Description: “Free legal TV for Gulf expats. No signup. Human-posted.”
- Human publishes. Automation may draft.
- No forward-from-unknown-channels. No broadcast lists that spam personal numbers.
- Deep link every post to a specific shelf, not always the homepage.
- Image first, 2–4 lines of text, one URL. People do not read essays in WhatsApp.

4.1 Weekly cadence template (non-Ramadan)

Slot	When (Gulf time)	Format	Purpose
W1 Open	Monday 18:00	Poster + 3 lines	One shelf, one language
W2 Live	Wednesday 20:00	Text + one live category	“What is actually up tonight” — only channels that passed the last health check
W3 Weekend	Friday 17:30	Poster + 4-title list	Weekend VOD from real catalog counts

Slot	When (Gulf time)	Format	Purpose
W4 Optional	Sunday 12:00	Reply-to-question	Only if someone asked; otherwise skip

Ramadan (1 Feb–10 Mar 2027): W1 daily at 17:30, short. Still human.

National / festival days: replace W3 with the festival poster. Do not add a fifth post “because it is Diwali.” Three posts and one extra is the cap outside Ramadan.

4.2 Poster formats (make four templates, reuse all year)

All on #0a0a0f, orange → pink gradient, Whisco wordmark, no stock family smiling at a laptop.

ID	Size	Use	On the canvas
P-SQ	1080×1080	Channel + Feed	Headline, one number (672 / 2,500+ / 61 / 581), URL
P-ST	1080×1920	Status / Stories / Reels cover	Same, more vertical UI screenshot
P-SPLIT	1080×1080	Two-language week	EN left, native script right, same claim
P-HONEST	1080×1080	Complaint-led	“We don’t have IPL. We do have tonight’s films.”

File naming: YYYY-MM-DD_community_template.png so the founder can find last year’s Onam.

4.3 Voice

- Expat-first. Assume the reader just finished a shift.
- Specific numbers when we have them. No “thousands of amazing shows.”
- Never “download our APK.” Store links or the site.
- Never mock religion, nationality, or the job that brought people here.
- English default; switch script when the week belongs to that community. Transliteration is fine if the founder cannot typeset Malayalam/Tamil that day — better honest EN than broken native.

4.4 Eight weeks of example posts

Catalog references are category-level on purpose. Do not name a serial as “on Whisco” unless the row is live that morning. Swap in a real title from the admin before publishing.

Week 1 — 6–12 Oct 2026 · Legal apartment setup (EN)

P-HONEST.

The building said no dish. The stick froze again.

Whisco is the legal version of that living room: 581 live channels that get checked every six hours, and 15,696 on-demand titles. No signup. One ad, not on the video.

whisco.tv

Week 2 — 13–19 Oct 2026 · Durga Puja / Bengali + Hindi

P-SPLIT.

Puja week in the Gulf.

Bengali and Hindi shelves are on the site — official films and series, not a festival IPTV pack. If you only open one thing this week, open the Bengali row and stay there.

whisco.tv

Week 3 — 20–26 Oct 2026 · Dussehra + Tamil/Telugu

P-SQ.

Dussehra weekend.

Tamil and Telugu films, legal, on the phone after the puja call home. We are not Sun NXT and we will not pretend to be. We are the free legal shelf that actually opens on a Bahrain or Dubai IP.

whisco.tv

Week 4 — 27 Oct – 2 Nov 2026 · Turkish dizi, still new-season

P-SQ.

The new Turkish season started in September. The pirate upload is still 360p.

61 series. About 3,650 episodes. Official sources. English or Arabic path, depending on the title.

whisco.tv

Week 5 — 3–9 Nov 2026 · Diwali

P-SQ, diya on dark UI.

2,500+ official Hindi films. No card. No 'free trial'.

Play one tonight. Leave the fireworks to the window.

whisco.tv

Week 6 — 10–16 Nov 2026 · Chhath + weekend Hindi

P-ST.

Chhath is the 15th and 16th.

If you need the TV on while the house is busy, the Hindi cinema shelf is the least-wrong thing we can offer. We do not have every serial from back home. We do not bill you for the ones we have.

whisco.tv

Week 7 — 17–23 Nov 2026 · Arabic series for mixed flats

P-SQ.

333 Arabic series. About 7,100 episodes.

For the flat where one remote has to serve Arabic and everything else. Free. Legal. No VIP

gate on this page.
whisco.tv

Week 8 — 24–30 Nov 2026 · Guru Nanak + Punjabi cinema, then December preview P-SPLIT.

Monday is Guru Nanak Jayanti.

Punjabi cinema and news FTA — not a sermon, just the shelf. Next month we talk Pasko for the Filipino side of the house. Same app. Same rule. Legal or it is not on the site.
whisco.tv

Ramadan alternate (drop in Feb 2027, daily short)

P-ST.

After maghrib.

Arabic series, Turkish dizi, Urdu and Hindi serials. One ad. No password. We will not send you a prayer-time table. We will keep the stream up.
whisco.tv

4.5 What never goes on the Channel

- Dead channels. Check the health job before a “live tonight” post.
- Sports fixtures we do not carry.
- Another company’s trailer.
- “Limited offer” language. There is no offer.
- Polls that ask people to name pirate apps.
- Automated good-morning images.

4.6 Measurement (honest)

Track weekly, by hand if needed:

Week of	Follows (start / end)	Posts shipped	Site sessions with utm_source=whatsapp	Notes
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A Channel with 400 serious Gulf followers beats a page with 12,000 empty ones. Do not buy subscribers.

5. Community posting rules (so paid and owned do not get us banned)

From the community map. Non-negotiable.

- **Do post (human, answer-first):** Expat.com Bahrain existing Firestick / Netflix threads. Indusladies UAE experience replies. r/cordcutters with Self-Promo flair if

the rule still exists. r/ABCDesis on a Jadoo thread. Abu Dhabi Q&A by Freya — text answer, no bare link.

- **Ask first / soft:** Pakistanis in Dubai, Pilipino Sa Kuwait, InterNations Manama events.
- **Do not post product URLs:** ExpatWoman, Dubai Mallu Chat Telegram, unofficial dizi/movie Telegram dumps, any group whose rules say no business links.
- Pattern: *“You’re in Bahrain and Hotstar / iWant / the stick failed. Here is the legal catalog that does work, and what still needs a paid sports app.”*

One helpful reply a week is the quota. A founder who “goes viral” in six groups in one night is a spammer.

6. Monthly scorecard (print this, do not decorate it)

Month: _____
Cash spent on Meta: \$_____ / \$110
Ad sets live at month-end: _____
Winning community / angle: _____
WhatsApp follows (start → end): _____ → _____
WhatsApp posts shipped: _____
Store reviews received / answered: _____ / _____
ASO experiment running: _____
Seasonal landing live?: Y/N
Human community replies: _____
Things we refused to do this month: _____

If the scorecard is empty two months in a row, stop making posters and go fix the catalog.

7. Open items that will change this plan

- iOS review decision (submitted 2 Sep 2026).
- Play closed-test 14-day clock / public listing.
- AdSense re-review (~mid-Sep 2026). Paid traffic onto a site that cannot show ads is still allowed (install / habit) but the unit economics stay zero.
- Filmhub / own-player licensed titles — the day a real file ships, every poster can show *our* player instead of an embed.
- PDPL counsel on a web analytics / ads pixel.
- Official moon-sighting for Ramadan and both Eids.
- Locked IPL 2027 and PSL 2027 fixtures.

Until those flip, this playbook stays small on purpose.

— End — *Whisco TV · Bahrain · 5 Sep 2026 · requires no legal privilege; ad targeting and store metadata should be re-checked inside the live ads and developer consoles before publish.*